

Ben Chidgey

Contract full-stack engineer · feedMyPixel Ltd · Remote worldwide, UK based

ben@feedmypixel.com

feedmypixel.com · github.com/feedmypixel · linkedin.com/in/benchidgey

Twenty years building software, mostly long-standing resilient services and products that need to be secure, host large numbers of users, have features added, removed and refactored. Simple, Lego bricks that combine to create very powerful, reliable software. Most of the time a refinement of a complex business function into software, software that works for everyone on all devices. I take a user/business need, an idea, or an issue that needs addressing, and build a product/function/service end to end: design, front end, API, microservices, infrastructure and more, in an iterable, testable fashion, focused on quality user experience and robust, maintainable, testable, resilient products that provide business value and fantastic user experiences. I am equally happy as an individual developer or joining a team with multiple developers, designers and analysts. Simple, testable, iterable software. Built against user and business needs. Most importantly I build what you need and to build what you need I start off by understanding what is needed. Going back to basic user/business need and then grabbing my pencils and my sketch pad.

Recent work is SvelteKit, TypeScript, Node, Fastify, AI and AWS, for Whisky Invest Direct. Working with Hapi.js, AWS, JavaScript, CSS and HTML for UK Government, DEFRA. React, TypeScript, GCP, Next.js for Wayfair and Pret. Long-standing UK Government, Guardian and BBC contractor. Lots of best practices and great learning experiences gained along the way.

Having extensive knowledge and experience around how things work across my disciplines is the offering I provide to clients. Delving deep into code, design, architecture and product combined with my knowledge and understanding provides autonomy and answers to build and deliver products that meet needs within time frames. It enables me to avoid the bear traps and rabbit holes, and through the use of best practices and tried and tested methodologies, my skills provide business value from the get-go. If you need direction and solutions to what may seem like an unknown or unclear path, I can help. If you need a concrete product that meets your user and business needs, I can take care of that. If you need someone to guide you to a new product that currently lives in your head, let's have a chat.

I love what I do, as do my clients and their users.

Skills

Core TypeScript, JavaScript, CSS, HTML, SvelteKit, Node, Fastify, AWS

Also React, Next.js, GraphQL, Postgres, MongoDB, Terraform, GitHub Actions

Throughout Accessibility, progressive enhancement, performance, testing, CI/CD, mentoring, UX, DX

Experience

Whisky Invest Direct

Apr 2026 to present

Full-Stack Engineer · Remote and London · Contract

Leading a greenfield rebuild of the core trading platform and API. Rebuild of the iOS and Android apps. Modernising of the architecture and embedding User Experience, Developer Experience, testing, accessibility and delivery best practice across engineering and product.

TypeScript, JavaScript, CSS, HTML, SvelteKit, Fastify, Capacitor, iOS, Android, AWS, Vitest, Playwright, Accessibility, Observability, CI/CD

DEFRA

Mar 2023 to Feb 2026

Full-Stack Platform Engineer · Remote · Contract

Designed and built the Core Delivery Platform Portal and APIs from a blank page. The Portal is the one-stop developer shop for microservice templates, testing tools, prototype kits and package libraries alongside the supporting platforms infrastructure, observability and monitoring, all on demand.

The Portal provides an admin UI for the Platform team and gives tenant teams a UI to create, manage, release and run their services, tooling, infra and team users. Sitting at the core of DEFRA's software offering and upholding parity and standards across the estate.

It went from a concept to the way software gets built at DEFRA. GDS reported first releases falling from three to six months down to hours and recovery from failure from a week to under an hour.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Node, Hapi, MongoDB, GOV.UK Frontend, Nunjucks, AWS, Docker, Vitest, WDIO, GitHub Actions, Accessibility, Design system, Templates, Postgres

Wayfair

Jan 2022 to Dec 2022

Software Engineer · Aug 2022 to Dec 2022 · Remote · Contract

Built the Freight Portal frontend microservice for Global Transportation Services, where users find and interact with every Wayfair facility service.

TypeScript, JavaScript, CSS, HTML, React, Kubernetes, Jest, Cypress, Micro frontend, Accessibility, DataDog

Senior Frontend Engineer and Tech Lead · Jan 2022 to Aug 2022 · Remote · Contract

Tech lead on the Global Customs Platform team, creating the Customs Portal frontend microservice.

TypeScript, JavaScript, CSS, HTML, React, Kubernetes, Jest, Cypress, Accessibility, DataDog, BuildKite

Pret A Manger

Jan 2021 to Dec 2021

Platform Engineer · Remote · Contract

Built a custom developer Backstage platform, Disco. A Backstage plugin serving SRE and Accelerate metrics from a TypeScript function and Express API over Postgres. Rolled out Sentry observability with Terraform, created Next.js and Express template repositories and ran chaos experiments and incident exercises with platform teams.

TypeScript, JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Node, React, Next.js, GCP, Lambda, Terraform, Backstage, Postgres, Sentry, Jest, Cypress

LifeBox Health

Jul 2020 to Dec 2020

Senior Full-Stack Developer · Brighton and Remote · Contract

Took on a React codebase grown over several years and stalled midway through the move from class to function components. Brought in functional patterns, testing and quality. Improved both the user experience and the developer experience while working alongside the junior developers on the team.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, React, GraphQL, Node, AWS, Lambda, Jest, CodeceptJS, Accessibility, Mentoring

Rewind

Feb 2020 to Mar 2020

Senior Frontend Developer · St Albans · Contract

Brought in as the specialist to get a late project over the line: the Leaflet mapping inside the Dubai Expo 2020 app.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Node, Leaflet, Accessibility

Ministry of Justice

Aug 2019 to Dec 2019

Senior Full-Stack Developer · London · Contract

Frontend for booking secure moves on the Prisoner Escort and Custody Service, a paper to digital transformation delivered with designers and user researchers. Built document upload as a whole vertical: the multi-file upload component, its controller and API model, size limits and client side error handling, the translations and both unit and end to end coverage. Handed it over on leaving and it stayed in the service for years afterwards.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Node, Express, GOV.UK, Nunjucks, Pattern library, Progressive enhancement, Kubernetes, Jest, Testcafe, Accessibility

Marks and Spencer

Apr 2019 to Aug 2019

Senior Full-Stack Developer · London · Contract

Framework team, building the shared tooling and component library used by teams across the dot-com business and worked with the bespoke in-house JavaScript framework, whilst React was brought in to various departments across the business.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Node, Express, React, Architecture, Pattern library, Concourse, Jest, Progressive enhancement, Accessibility, Mentoring

HM Passport Office

Oct 2018 to Dec 2018

Senior Full-Stack Developer · London · Contract

Inherited a legacy appointment booking system and its public journeys, established how it actually behaved, then proposed a roadmap with the design team and carried it through senior stakeholders. The team rebuilt it in-house as Node microservices.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Node, Express, Microservices, GOV.UK Pay, Home Office Forms, Redis, Jest, Progressive enhancement, Accessibility

Department for International Trade

May 2017 to Mar 2018

Senior Full-Stack Developer · London · Contract

Software and infrastructure for the Data Hub team, enabling civil servants to manage the business relationships behind UK trade and investment.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Node, Express, React, Vue, Nunjucks, Docker, Redis, SSO, CircleCI, Nightwatch, Pattern library, Accessibility, Architecture

HM Revenue and Customs

Sep 2015 to Apr 2017

Senior Frontend Developer · Sep 2016 to Apr 2017 · London · Contract

Created the HMRC design language in a small team, with the documentation, process and principles behind it, so designers and developers could build frontend services for the Tax Platform with parity across HMRC. Worked closely with GDS and partnered on the first releases of the GOV.UK Frontend.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Design system, Pattern library, Frontend operations, Node, Scala, Sass, AWS, Responsive, Accessibility, Documentation, Mentoring, GOV.UK Frontend

Senior Frontend Developer · Feb 2016 to Sep 2016 · London · Contract

Tackled frontend architecture across the Tax Platform with Platform Operations. Refactored shared assets, exposed components through a component library and mentored frontend developers and designers on how to approach common problems.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Frontend architecture, Component library, React, Node, Scala, Sass, Responsive, Accessibility, Mentoring

Frontend Developer · Sep 2015 to Feb 2016 · London · Contract

Built user interfaces for HMRC digital services. Implemented Government Gateway two factor authentication and registration, generic client and server form validation for Identity Verification and the API documentation site.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Scala, Node, Sass, Responsive, Security, Forms, Accessibility

Department for Work and Pensions

Apr 2015 to May 2015

Frontend Developer · London · Contract

Universal Credit. Analysed a mature codebase and presented frontend improvements, tackled technical debt and built rapid prototyping tools and workflows for the UX and design team.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Node, Sass, FlightJS, Jasmine, Grunt, Responsive, Prototyping, Accessibility

Guardian News and Media

Apr 2014 to Apr 2015

Client-Side Engineer · London · Contract

Membership team, building the beta responsive site and its tools. Lean agile with Scala and micro JavaScript libraries, pair programming, code review and continuous integration.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Node, Scala, Sass, BEM, Responsive, Jasmine, Grunt, CI, Pair programming, Code review, Mentoring

feedMyPixel

Feb 2014 to Mar 2014**Research and Development · St Albans · Freelance**

Research and development between contracts, getting to know AngularJS as well as other side projects.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Angular

Deutsche Telekom UK

Oct 2012 to Dec 2013**Mobile Frontend Developer · Hatfield · Contract**

Responsive work across several products: a client dashboard, a globally distributed header injected into many Telekom pages, an SMS to web prototype that became the company Node skeleton and a rebuilt advertising asset platform.

JavaScript, CSS3, HTML5, Responsive, Node, Express, Jessie, Mobile

BBC

Aug 2011 to Aug 2012**Software Engineer · London · Contract**

Future Media Core Services on iBroadcast2, a next generation media and metadata publishing platform behind iPlayer, scheduling and BBC websites. Fortnight sprints with PHP, jQuery and Cucumber.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, PHP, Zend, jQuery, LessCSS, TDD, BDD, REST, Pair programming

eDigitalResearch

Apr 2010 to Jul 2011**Application Support Developer · Southampton · Permanent**

Supported the applications, websites and in-house tools behind customer insight analytics for clients including Sky, BT, Expedia, Virgin and the BBC.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, PHP, Zend, jQuery, MooTools, PostgreSQL

Freelance

Oct 2007 to Apr 2010**Web Developer and Designer · Southampton · Freelance**

Development across a large dynamic website driven by a hand-built content management system, culminating in the Lazy Gramophone platform.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, PHP, MySQL, SEO, UX, CMS

Lazy Gramophone

2004 to 2010**Web Developer and Designer · Remote · Freelance**

A community publishing platform and bespoke CMS for the arts collective and publisher, built from the ground up in PHP and MySQL, with editing tools for artists to manage their own work, an invite and management facility and comment moderation.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, PHP, MySQL, Photoshop, UX, SEO, CMS

Design Haus

Mar 2010**Frontend Developer · Southampton · Freelance**

An internal intranet for Diageo, built in jQuery and Mustache.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, jQuery, Mustache, Photoshop, UX

Trusted Digital

Jan 2007 to Oct 2007**Product Design Manager · Brighton · Permanent**

Interactive SMS marketing services for mobile handsets and the mobile web, built in Mobile Profile HTML. Making the case for purpose-built mobile experiences years before mobile first became normal practice.

XHTML-MP, CSS, Photoshop, SEO

Hotxt

Aug 2006 to Dec 2006**Quality Assurance Manager · London · Permanent**

Introduced a QA testing structure for a J2ME text over IP start-up across many handsets and networks, forming the beginnings of an in-house QA department.

QA, Mobile, J2ME

Freelance

Oct 2005 to Jul 2006**Developer and Designer · Brighton · Freelance**

Web and mobile media, J2ME game graphics and 3D modelling, including the 3D work for the Concorde2 website and the Battleships mobile game.

JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Flash, Photoshop, 3ds Max, Premiere, J2ME, Design

Babel Media

Aug 2002 to Sep 2005

QA Technician · Brighton · Permanent

Console TRC certification for PS2 and GameCube, then started the mobile J2ME QA department and grew it from three people to over 150, adapting testing procedures to new workloads and operator requirements.

| Game QA, Mobile QA, Sony TRC, Microsoft certification, Test-track Pro, Process

Education

University of Hertfordshire

1999 to 2002

BA (Hons) Software Systems for the Arts and Media, 2.1.

The degree covered computer programming, computer systems and hardware, computer generated imaging, digital image and sound processes, digital time-based and interactive media, principles and theory of hypermedia design, virtual reality and cyber culture.

Oxford College of Further Education

1999

City and Guilds Certificate of Information Technology for Computing. City and Guilds Certificate of Information Technology for Visual Basic 1.

Gosford Hill School, Kidlington

1988 to 1994

GCSE English Literature [A](#), English Language [A](#), Geography [A](#), Science [AA](#), Business Studies [B](#), Mathematics [B](#), History [C](#), Craft Design and Technology [D](#).

References

Available on request.